Uppsala Monitoring Centre

Frequently Asked Questions

Use of WHODrug Global C3 format to meet regulatory expectations in Latin America

UMC's Drug Dictionary – WHODrug Global is a global and standardised terminology for medicines and vaccines, developed, maintained and distributed by Uppsala Monitoring Centre (UMC), an independent, not-for-profit foundation.

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Disclaimer

The information provided in this document regarding regulatory expectations for UMC's Drug Dictionary, WHODrug Global, is intended for general guidance and may not always reflect the most recent updates. UMC assumes no responsibility for any inaccuracies, interpretations, or actions taken based on this information.

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This disclaimer applies to the entire document, including but not limited to information related to license requirements, regulatory compliance, and any other relevant topics.

Changes from previous version

Version	Summary of changes
Version 3	Updated to reflect the Old form renaming to Archived Record. 4.Included Nicaragua and Ecuador in the list of countries with regulatory expectations for WHODrug Global in the Latin America region. 7.Included the link with instructions from Nicaragua and Ecuador on how to activate licenses on the Industry eReporting platform.
Version 2	**WHODrug** 2.Updated the languages in which the "Introduction to WHODrug" course is available. 4.Included Brazil, Panama and Uruguay in the list of countries with regulatory expectations for WHODrug Global in the Latin America region. **Licenses** 1.Updated the process for obtaining a WHODrug license. 2.New question added. 3.New question added. 4.New question added. 5.Revised and updated the Access Manager section to reflect current processes. 7.Included the link with instructions from Uruguay and Brazil on how to activate licenses on the Industry eReporting platform. **Change Request** 3.Made minor clarifications and refinements to the description of the Change Request process. 6.Made minor clarifications and refinements to the answer. 8.New question added.

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WHODrug

1. What is WHODrug Global?

UMC's Drug Dictionary, WHODrug Global, is the international reference for medicinal product information, and it is maintained by Uppsala Monitoring Centre (UMC).

The WHODrug dictionary is a worldwide source of global medicinal information with the aim to facilitate the coding of medications in clinical trials as well as identification of medication-related problems when monitoring patient safety, thereby supporting the development and use of effective and safe medications.

2. Are there any training programs available for WHODrug?

In the WHODrug section on the UMC website you can find the **online self-study course** "**Introduction to WHODrug**". The course is available in English, Spanish, and Portuguese. It provides basic knowledge of the concepts required to use WHODrug, and upon completion, it is possible to print a course certificate.

In the WHODrug section on the UMC website you can also find **WHODrug Webinars**, available in two different series:

- The **Essentials** webinar series is a set of introductory presentations on WHODrug basics and applications and are available in several languages.
- The **Extended** webinar series is a set of presentations focusing on new developments and innovative use of WHODrug, with the participation of guest speakers.
- Recordings of these webinars are also available in the WHODrug section on the UMC website.

3. Where can I access additional resources on WHODrug, including guides and best practices?

In the WHODrug section on the UMC website, a wide range of information about WHODrug is available such as **WHODrug user guides and best coding practices**, as well **as video tutorials**, all of which are freely accessible to licensed WHODrug users.

4. What are the regulatory expectations for WHODrug Global in the Latin America region?

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For the most accurate and up-to-date guidance, please consult the relevant regulatory authority directly:

Country	Effective date	Guidance
Mexico	January 1, 2024	Available here
Argentina	October 5, 2024	Available here
Colombia	March 1, 2025	Available here
Uruguay	July 13, 2025	Available here
Panama	March 1, 2026	Available here (Page 88, Article 318)
Brazil	March 21, 2026	Available here
Nicaragua	January 21, 2026	Available here
Ecuador	September 30, 2026	Available here

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Licenses

1. How can I obtain a WHODrug license?

To apply for a WHODrug license, visit https://who-umc.org/whodrug/whodrug-subscription/ and complete the license application form. The average processing time for obtaining a license is approximately 3 weeks.

2. Are WHODrug licenses subscription-based?

Yes, all WHODrug licenses are subscription-based. This means that licenses are valid for a specific period (usually one year) and will automatically renew unless you actively cancel them within the cancellation period. This applies to both standard and discounted licenses.

3. How does the renewal process work?

Your WHODrug license will be automatically renewed unless you actively cancel it. You will receive a **Renewal Acknowledgement** well in advance of your subscription's start date. From the date you receive this notice, you will have **30 days** to cancel your license. If no cancellation is received within these 30 days, your subscription will be automatically renewed, and full payment will be required.

For discounted licenses, an annual review based on financial and other eligibility criteria will also be performed.

4. What documents are required for the annual review of discounted licenses?

UMC will contact you **4 months** before the renewal period to request the necessary documents. Your organization must submit financial reports for the past three years. The annual financial report should include the balance sheet, income statement, and, if available or requested, the cash flow statement. These documents can typically be obtained from your finance department. Please ensure timely submission to avoid any disruptions to your subscription

5. How can I manage user access to WHODrug and its applications?

Access to WHODrug Global Standard and Worldwide Corporate Licenses is managed via **WHODrug Access Manager**, a self-service web application for handling user accounts. Each company holding a Global Standard or Corporate license appoints an *Access Manager* responsible for overseeing and managing access through this tool.

For more information or to access **WHODrug Access Manager**, you can visit https://www.who-umc.org/whodrug/subscription/whodrug-access-manager/ or watch a short video explaining the tool. If you have additional questions or need to change the role of the designated Access Manager, please do not hesitate to contact us at support@who-umc.org.

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As for WHODrug licences for Industry eReporting, up to three users can be assigned. To manage these user accesses, please send a request to support@who-umc.org.

6. What should I do if I cannot identify the Access Manager or if they have left the company?

If you are unable to identify your company's Access Manager or if they are no longer with the company, please contact us at support@who-umc.org for assistance.

7. Where can I learn more about the WHODrug Vendor Programme?

You can find more information and a list of certified vendors on our WHODrug Vendor Programme page: https://who-umc.org/whodrug/whodrug-vendor-programme/.

8. Which license type complies with the C3 format required by regional authorities?

All WHODrug Global license types (WHODrug Global Standard, Corporate and WHODrug for Industry eReporting) comply with the C3 format.

We remind you that it is important to activate your license on the Industry eReporting platform and instructions on how to do so are available in the manuals of each authority:

- COFEPRIS (Mexico): Available here
- ANMAT (Argentina): Available here
- INVIMA (Colombia): Available here
- MSP (Uruguay): Available here
- MINSA (Panama): Available here
- Anvisa (Brazil): Available here
- ANRS (Nicaragua): Available here
- ARCSA (Ecuador): Available here

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Change Request

1. What is a change request?

A change request allows for the inclusion of a new drug in WHODrug or the modification of an existing record. All requests submitted by users within the same organisation are visible to all members of that organisation.

The submitter receives a notification about the change request, and accepted requests are normally included in the next available version of WHODrug. Newly approved drug names will be included in the earliest possible release of WHODrug, and drug details can be viewed instantly in WHODrug Insight's "*Upcoming data*".

2. Is it the responsibility of the pharmaceutical industry to ensure all product information in WHODrug is complete?

Yes, it is considered good practice to ensure that your products are accurately and comprehensively documented in WHODrug. This is particularly important in countries where compliance with WHODrug is a regulatory requirement.

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3. How do I proceed to make a change request?

Before requesting a new drug, please verify that it is not already present in WHODrug Insight *Upcoming Data*. Afterward, please review your company's products listed on WHODrug. The method for doing so depends on your license type.

a) For WHODrug Global Standard and Worldwide Corporate Licenses:

- Log in to the WHODrug section on the UMC website and select "WHODrug Insight".
- Alternatively, access the tool directly via https://insight.who-umc.org/.
- Choose the "Extended Drug Search" tab.
- Enter your country in the "Country" section and your company name in the "MAH" section.
- Click "Search" and export the results as an Excel list using the "Export" button.
- Review your product information in WHODrug.

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b) For WHODrug licenses for Industry eReporting:

- Make sure your license is active in Industry eReporting.
- Individually review your products in the manual entry module by searching for them in the WHODrug-marked sections within the tool. Verify that your product information is accurate and complete.

To request changes:

- Log in to the WHODrug section on the UMC website and select "WHODrug Change Request."
- Alternatively, access the tool directly via https://changerequest.who-umc.org/External.
- For individual requests, choose "Request New Drug" select the C3 format and provide the requested information. Attach also the reference(s) and specify relevant details in the comments.
- For batch requests, refer to the "Request New Drug batch" tab for the process. Download the Excel C3 template, complete it, and upload it via the WHODrug Change Request service. After submitting the batch request template, users can track the progress of their submissions.
- If it's not possible to include the reference(s) in the Excel file, please send it via email to support@who-umc.org, including the change request ID in the subject line for easy association.
- If WHODrug information is inaccurate, use the "Suggest Dictionary Modification" option. Attach reference(s) of the products registered in the relevant country for review and validation by our content team.

Two separate tutorial videocasts—one on the updated Change Request tool and another on the Extended Drug Search tab in WHODrug Insight—are available in the WHODrug section on the UMC website under the *Videocast* section. Both videos are available in English, Spanish, and Portuguese.

Note that some authorities may require a copy of the request so confirm this requirement with each authority.

4. Is there a limit on the number of changes allowed in a Change Request, and can requests be submitted at any time?

There is no limit on the number of changes allowed, and requests can be submitted at any time.

5. Once a change is made through Change Request, when is it reflected in WHODrug?

Individual changes typically take around 3 business days and these changes are reflected in real time in Industry eReporting (manual data entry module), WHODrug Insight (*Upcoming data*),

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and the WHODrug Download API service (currently available for Regulators). Please note that complex requests and large batch requests may require longer time to process.

If your company uses WHODrug files that are updated twice a year (in March and September), it generally takes approximately two months to download, validate, and implement the update in the system. In large global organizations, where a central team coordinates this process across multiple countries, the timeline may be extended further. During the interim period while waiting for the updated version to become available, companies may either perform reporting through manual data entry in Industry eReporting or rely on the following justifications: "Use the most recent version available at the time of reporting" and "Use a placeholder temporarily."

6. What if my change request was rejected and I disagree?

If your change request is rejected and you disagree with the decision, it is possible to resubmit your request, with additional information, via support@who-umc.org. Our team of specialists will review your request again, and we'll provide you with a detailed response to help you understand and justify the decision.

7. How should we proceed with modifying or registering a drug for sale in another country?

We recommend submitting separate WHODrug update requests for each country. We also advise confirming the specific requirements and procedures for making this request with the relevant regulatory authority in the country.

Additionally, if your organization reports or uses WHODrug in the new location, you may need to add that location to your license.

8. How should I handle cases where a product from my company is listed in WHODrug, but it was either revoked or never commercialized?

Products with cancelled or revoked market authorizations will remain active in WHODrug. This ensures that identifiable products, which may still be available on the market despite lacking current authorization, can still be coded in case an adverse drug reaction report is submitted.

These products are marked in WHODrug with the label "Archived record". While UMC strives to keep WHODrug accurate and up to date, it is important to note that capturing the marketing status of medicinal products is not the primary focus of WHODrug. In the C3 format, the "Archived record" designation can be found as an additional feature file. In the manual data entry module of Industry eReporting, an exclamation mark (!) will appear when attempting to code such a product, indicating its status.

The process for managing these cases — including which references to include — may vary depending on the regulatory authority. Please consult the relevant authority for detailed guidance.

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